



Academic Report - Semester Two 2023 Year 12

From the Principal

Year 12, thank you for being so wonderful. We have so much faith in each and every one of you. We have witnessed your growth as young adults, leaders, and friends. The way you supported each other in the Senior School Library has been heartwarming. The way you worked collaboratively together, provided an exemplary model for every Year 12 class that will follow. You all personified the adage that we are all only strong as each other.

You have the strength, support and abilities to realise your hopes, aspirations, and dreams. The major works that were produced were innovative, creative and inspiring. The academic results have steadily improved with your commitment to study and with the excellent support of our staff and the alumni academic tutors.

A school culture is shaped and led by our Year 12 school leaders. You have led this school with dignity, respect and a genuine love for Hills Grammar and its teachers. Your impact on our school will be long lasting.

These final Academic Reports are a culmination of thirteen years of schooling. You are encouraged to reflect and develop a plan of action for the weeks ahead, in the knowledge that considerable gains can be made in terms of consolidating knowledge, deepening learning and refining skills, all of which will translate into improved marks and performance. Maintaining momentum, independence and autonomy are crucial at this point in the journey. Setbacks and gaps in knowledge can be addressed. It is not over until the final HSC examination.

Move into the next chapter of your life's journey knowing that you have so much to give, so much to learn and so much to achieve. Ralph Waldo Emerson said, *"What lies behind us and what lies before us are small matters compared to what lies within us."*

I wish you all the best in the HSC examinations and in your future endeavours. Congratulations to the students who have received early entry to universities or cadetships. With your courage, determination, and strength, I know that you will flourish. Thank you for being an extraordinary group of young people!

Ms Karen Yager
Principal

Semester Two 2023

Reporting Student Achievement in Year 12

The School provides parents and caregivers with ongoing information and guidance on each student's growth in scholarship, personal development and citizenship. Such information is shared in several ways.

Information Evenings

Parents and students are invited to attend a function where senior teachers explain specific issues and plans.

Parent, Student and Teacher Interviews

Academic interviews provide an opportunity for parents to discuss their child's achievement and application with each of their teachers.

Parent, Student and Mentor meetings

An opportunity for students and parents to meet with the Mentor and set goals for the year ahead.

Feedback on Assessment Tasks

Continuous reporting of progress on assessment tasks through the HG Engage App.

Semester Reports

Every semester a formal written report is provided to parents summarising a student's achievement and application in each subject.

How to Read this Academic Report

The Academic Report presents a comprehensive summary of a student's achievement and application for each course they are enrolled in. The information provided will normally include:

- progress on course outcomes
- an indicator of overall effort
- an overall A to E grade for each course (Years 1-11)
- a summary of results in the formal assessment program
- approaches to learning in class and home learning (half yearly report)
- teacher's comment, including areas for focus leading into final HSC Examinations (yearly report)

Progress on Course Outcomes

At Hills Grammar we report progress on course outcomes. An outcome, plainly speaking, is something that the student knows, understands or can do in a particular stage of learning K to 12. Assessment tasks and examinations focus on specific course outcomes. The following descriptors are to be used when interpreting a student's progress:

Working Towards:	Student is currently performing at a developing level on the outcome. They are working towards competence on the outcome.
Achieving:	Student is currently performing at a sound level on the outcome. They have achieved competence and are working towards proficiency on the outcome.
Proficient:	Student is currently performing at a high level on the outcome. They are working towards mastery and wider applications of the outcome.

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Reported Marks

Our formal assessment program includes between 3 and 4 assessments per subject for Year 12 and we report the individual results for each assessment. At the time of the half yearly report, either 1 or 2 assessment marks will be reported (AT1, AT2). The yearly report will include all completed assessment tasks, and an overall course mark, expressed as a percentage. The yearly report will include additional comparative data, such as course average and mark distribution.

Approaches to Learning

Contemporary education places great emphasis on the importance of the student's own role in learning. Rather than learning being a process where the teacher 'delivers' knowledge to the student, the School sees teachers and students engaged in a co-operative partnership where together they work to develop the student's understanding. We urge students to be active learners and to reflect on all the ways in which they are involved in learning in lessons and at home. The level of involvement and commitment are reported in the Approach to Learning. The descriptors used to define a student's Approach to Learning as indicated in this report are Consistently, Frequently, Sometimes and Rarely.

Teacher Analysis

After each assessment task, teachers will write a comment on student progress, published in HG Engage. In addition, the yearly report will include a summary of yearly examination performance and an overall comment on current strengths and areas for improvement. Students and their parents are encouraged to seek further feedback as required at the Student-Teacher-Parent Interviews and on other occasions throughout the year.

Semester Two 2023



Vraj Patel
Year 12 (121)
Mentor: Mrs Michele Lautre

Days Absent

Whole Days Absent: 5

Courses Studied	Units
English Advanced	2
Mathematics Advanced	2
Economics	2
Geography	2
Food Technology	2
Total Units	10

House Mentor Comment

Vraj is a polite and respectful student who has steadily worked to improve his knowledge and understanding in most of his subjects this semester, despite finding the demands of some of the subjects challenging. To improve his results further, I encourage Vraj to analyse the report comments made by each of his subject teachers and put into action the strategies that have been suggested. Vraj has continued to develop positive relationships with his peers and subject teachers, and it has been a pleasure having him in our Connect group this year. I wish him all the very best for the HSC examinations and for the future that lies ahead.



English Advanced

Ms Justine Zarebski

This semester, students have completed Module A: Textual Conversations, exploring the poetry of John Keats and the Jane Campion film Bright Star. The students completed their studies by developing skills in writing for Module C: The Craft of Writing. The position in course is based on all assessment tasks completed in the HSC course and is the final course ranking.

Effort

Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Needs Improvement
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Areas of Learning

Explains and evaluates nuanced cultural assumptions and values in texts and their effects on meaning	Achieving
Investigates and evaluates the relationships between texts	Achieving
Strategically adapts and applies knowledge, skills and understanding of language concepts and literary devices in new and different contexts	Achieving
Evaluates the diverse ways texts can represent personal and public worlds and recognises how they are valued	Working Towards

Assessment Tasks	Weight	Mark	Average
AT1 - Common Module	20%	7/20	13/20
AT2 - Module B	25%	9/20	13/20
AT3 - Module C	25%	11/20	14/20
AT4 - Trial examination	30%	42/100	63/100

Position in Course	47/49
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Vraj is a sound worker in class and tries to do his best to respond to activities and tasks. He has a developing understanding of the texts set for study and is able to respond using textual references. Vraj is advised to read widely, including academic material, in order to improve his understanding of set texts. Greater contextual awareness of the texts is needed to substantiate his arguments. Vraj is strongly encouraged to practise writing under timed conditions, review his notes and submit work for individualised feedback.



Mathematics Advanced

Mrs Rachel Sinclair

Students have covered the following areas of study this semester: Finance, Sequences and Series, Motion and Rates and Trigonometric Functions. Course revision together with a review of examination technique has been undertaken throughout this period. The position in course is based on all assessment tasks completed in the HSC course and is the final course ranking.

Effort

Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Needs Improvement
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Areas of Learning	
Applies the concepts and techniques of arithmetic and geometric sequences and series in the solution of problems	Working Towards
Solves problems using appropriate statistical processes	Proficient
Applies the concepts and techniques of periodic functions in the solution of problems involving trigonometric graphs	Working Towards
Uses detailed algebraic and graphical techniques to critically construct, model and evaluate arguments in a range of familiar and unfamiliar contexts	Working Towards
Applies the concepts and techniques of indefinite and definite integrals in the solution of problems	Working Towards
Applies calculus techniques to model and solve problems	Working Towards

Assessment Tasks	Weight	Mark	Average
AT1 - Discrete Probability Distributions and Data	20%	62/95	79/95
AT2 - Curve Sketching, Integration, Exp and Logs	25%	13/42	28/42
AT3 - Trigonometry, Motion/Rates, Sequences/Series	25%	19/36	28/36
AT4 - Trial examination	30%	36/100	66/100

Position in Course	33/34
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Vraj has been working steadily to strengthen his skills and understanding in Mathematics. He showed improvement in Task 3 but had difficulty consolidating his understanding of all the Year 11 and 12 concepts in preparation for the Trial examination. Vraj is to be commended for achieving full marks in the Statistics questions but needs to revise the key concepts in all other topics, with a focus on strengthening his algebra and problem-solving skills. He is encouraged to complete the topic-based revision worksheets in Teams and complete a wide variety of past papers under timed examination conditions, following up with questions as necessary. Keep up the hard-work, Vraj!



Economics

Mrs Rebecca Summerhays

This semester students completed two units of inquiry, Australia's Place in the Global Economy and Economic Policies and Management. In the first unit, students examined where Australia fits into the global economy and the impact of changes in the global economy on Australia's internal and external stability. In the second unit, students examined Australia's macroeconomic and microeconomic policies, including the operation and implications of fiscal and monetary policies. The position in course is based on all assessment tasks completed in the HSC course and is the final course ranking.

Effort

Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Needs Improvement
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Areas of Learning	
Analyses the economic role of individuals, firms, institutions and governments	Achieving
Analyses the impact of economic policies in theoretical and contemporary Australian contexts	Achieving
Demonstrates understanding of economic terms, concepts and relationships	Achieving
Discusses policy options for dealing with problems and issues in contemporary and hypothetical contexts	Achieving
Evaluates the consequences of contemporary economic problems and issues on individuals, firms and governments	Achieving

Assessment Tasks	Weight	Mark	Average
AT1 - Economics Issues	25%	24/40	30/40
AT2 - The Global Economy	20%	15/20	17/20
AT3 - Australia in the Global Economy	25%	11/20	15/20
AT4 - Trial examination	30%	55/100	78/100

Position in Course	13/14
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Vraj has demonstrated a sound understanding of the basic principles of economics. He demonstrated the ability to use appropriate structure in extended response questions. I encourage Vraj to continue to practise completing multiple choice and short answer questions and to apply relevant evidence and labelled models to support his responses. This will help him to further solidify his understanding of the material and improve his ability to answer questions in a clear and concise way. I am proud of the commitment that Vraj has demonstrated in his study of Economics and I wish him all the best for the future.



Geography

Ms Helen Laidler

This semester the students have studied the topic of People and Economic Activity, where they discovered the global importance of Tourism. For the local enterprise case study on Thredbo Resort, the students undertook and recorded data during fieldwork to research the impacts of providing a tourist destination in a fragile alpine ecosystem and the importance of balancing both ecological and economic resources. The students have also integrated skills and tools to deepen their understanding of mathematical and spatial information. The position in the course is based on all assessment tasks completed in the HSC course and is the final course ranking.

Effort

Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Needs Improvement
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Areas of Learning

Explains the changing nature, spatial patterns and interaction of ecosystems, urban places and economic activity	Working Towards
Analyses the changing spatial and ecological dimensions of an economic activity	Achieving
Analyses contemporary urban dynamics and applies them in specific contexts	Achieving
Explains the factors which place ecosystems at risk and the reasons for their protection	Achieving

Assessment Tasks	Weight	Mark	Average
AT1 - Skills	15%	14/30	21/30
AT2 - Urban Dynamics - Scavify	30%	28/40	32/40
AT3 - Ecosystems at Risk	25%	13/20	14/20
AT4 - Trial examination	30%	52/100	69/100

Position in Course	12/16
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Vraj demonstrates strength in calculating numeracy-based geographical skills such as gradient. He has also made a concerted effort to revise all skills work and has been rewarded with some solid results in the corresponding section of the Trial examination. I encourage Vraj to practise his written responses at every opportunity, focusing on decoding what each question is asking and understanding the meaning of each directive term. I also recommend that Vraj learns the correct geographic terminology and processes to use in his writing as he often writes about key topic areas in general terms, rather than with sophistication and clarity.



Food Technology

Ms Kelly Boyd

This semester, students have focused on the Australian Food Industry and Food Manufacture. The use of an investigative approach to the Australian Food Industry has enabled students to develop a deeper understanding of aspects of the Australian Food industry. The students have completed several food experiments which have supported their understanding and application in their Food Manufacture task. The position in course is based on the listed assessment tasks.

Effort

Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Needs Improvement
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Areas of Learning

Investigates operations of one organisation within the Australian food industry	Achieving
Applies principles of food preservation to extend the life of food and maintain safety	Achieving
Independently investigates contemporary nutrition issues	Proficient
Justifies processes of food product development and manufacture in terms of market, technological and environmental considerations	Achieving
Evaluates the relationship between food, its production, consumption, promotion and health	Achieving

Assessment Tasks	Weight	Mark	Average
AT1 - Australian Food Industry Case Study	20%	24/30	22/30
AT2 - Food Manufacture- Preservation	25%	23/35	25/35
AT3 - Food Product Development	30%	59/80	63/80
AT4 - Trial examination	25%	55/100	57/100

Position in Course	4/6
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Vraj has demonstrated a diligent attitude towards his study of Food Technology, working hard to compile study notes. His performance across assessment tasks has steadily improved and reflected his interest in the course. Moving towards the HSC examination, Vraj is encouraged to practise HSC extended responses to apply his knowledge, ensuring that he prioritises revising Food Manufacturing and The Australian Food Industry. It has been a pleasure teaching Vraj Food Technology during his time at Hills Grammar and I wish him all the best in his future endeavors.